

the Boss level will play? The Artist wants to know how big the boss is? All these questions would be normally answered in a GDD. And as teams grow to numbers in the hundreds and the production spans for 3-5 years for the bigger AAA games, it becomes crucial to have a one-stop ready reference for such games. Also, it is handy for newcomers in the team to be able use the GDD to know about the game rather than approach the Game Designer for every little doubt they may have. Point to be noted - apart from tuning the gameplay and brainstorming with your team for ideas, most of your time would be spent in documenting details about the game in relevant document using Microsoft Word.

Also, in this industry you have to keep up with the rest. Strength wise, it is a very small industry and everyone knows everyone. You will almost certainly work with a lot of people you meet in one or the other form. Later on in your career, you would essentially need to network with other Developers around the world and go to events like GDC, Casual Connect, PAX etc. to get some exposure.

As of today, in India - NASSCOM Gaming Forum on Facebook is a hangout place for the local Game Developers. It's a nice place to talk to professionals and get advice and even share ideas.

When do I start becoming a Game Designer? Is it too late for me?

OK, so you are finally starting to get a better picture in your mind about this and you think you want to make games. But wait... you are already working somewhere and it is not a game studio. Is it too late now? The simple answer is NO! Back in my Game Design school, we had students aged 17 to 32; one student being a lawyer-turned-Game Designer with a PhD. All that matters is passion coupled with practicality. If you are determined, you could always explore by learning things on your own. There are a lot of books, resources and videos on this topic. One could easily experiment with the wacky new ideas one may have and even prototype them if they know a programmer or can program themselves.

How do you convince your parents if you are too young?

"And how much does your girl / boy earn?" This is the age-old question parents (especially in India) dread. There is one thing the better part of this industry expects you to have - an attitude where you don't work for money but for the craft of it. Of course, it's not like they are not going to pay you. But